

3

CHAROTAR UNIVERSITY OF SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

Master of Business Administration (MBA)

Semester – II University Examination May 2010

MB 710 Written and Business Communication (WBC)

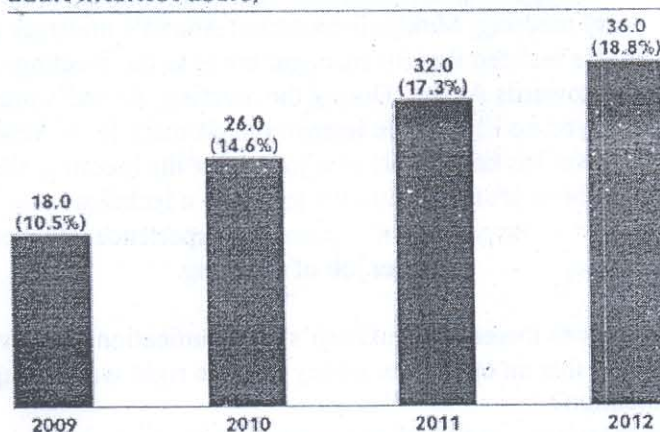
Date: 13.05.2010, Thursday Time: 12.30 p.m. to 3.30 p.m. Maximum Marks: 70

Instructions:

1. This paper contains six questions, of which the last one is a case analysis.
2. All questions are compulsory.
3. Each of the first five questions will carry 10 marks and the last case analysis will carry 20 marks.

- Q1. A. Elecon Information Technology Ltd. is seeking a marketing manager. Key responsibility of the manager will be to build a strong presence of the company in the Internet security software segment. Write an application for the job. [6]
B. Draft your resume keeping the above mentioned position in mind. [4]
- Q2. You have developed an Information Technology business model and need financial assistance to cultivate it. Craft your business proposal for submitting it to Google Ventures Ltd. for financing your project. [10]
- Q3. Silver Spring Networks has interviewed 5 candidates for the positions of sales executives. As an HR Manager of Silver Spring Networks, draft the appointment order for the selected candidates. Mention the rules and regulations to be observed while working with the company. [10]
- Q4. eMarketer, an Internet research firm recently surveyed about the usage of Twitter, a social networking website, among US adults (ages 18+). The following graph shows the growth of Twitter users. [10]

US Adult Twitter Users, 2009-2012 (millions and % of adult Internet users)



Note: ages 18+; Internet users who access Twitter via any platform at least monthly

Source: eMarketer, April 2010

114012

www.eMarketer.com

Write a research report in 300-400 words based on the graph. Make suitable

assumptions to add more findings to the report. Your report should answer the following questions:

- How many people in the US are using Twitter?
- How are usage patterns changing?
- What platforms do people use to access Twitter?
- How are companies marketing on Twitter?
- What are Twitter's revenue prospects?

- Q5. A. I²IM recently celebrated its fourth annual day. As General Secretary of I²IM, draft a press note to publish in a national newspaper. [6]
- B. Write a letter to Chief Editor, Times of India, with a request to publish the press note. [4]

- Q6. Read the following case and discuss the questions at the end. [20]

The president of Goodwill Corporation Ltd., Mr Abhishek Mukherji, wanted to facilitate upward communication. He believed an open-door policy was a good option. He announced that his own door was open to all employees and encouraged senior managers to do the same. He felt that this would give him a way to get early warning signals that would not be filtered or redirected through formal chain of command. Mukherji found that many employees who used the open-door policy had been with the company for years and were comfortable talking to the president. Sometimes messages came through about inadequate policies and procedures. Mukherji would raise these issues and explain any changes at the next senior managers' meeting. The most difficult complaints to handle were those from people who were not getting along with their bosses.

One employee, Anand, complained bitterly that his manager had over committed on behalf of the department and put everyone under tremendous pressure. Anand argued that long hours and low morale were major problems. However, he would not allow Mukherji to either bring the manager into the discussion or seek out other employees to confirm the complaint. Although Mukherji suspected Anand might be right, he could not let the matter lie and said, 'Have you considered leaving the company?' This made Anand realize that a meeting with his immediate boss was unavoidable.

Before the three-party meeting, Mukherji contacted Anand's manager and explained what was going on. He insisted that the manager come to the meeting willing to listen and without hostility towards Anand. During the meeting, Anand's manager listened attentively and displayed no ill will. He learned the problem from Anand's perspective and realized he was over his head in his new job. After the meeting, the manager said he was relieved. He had been promoted into the job from a technical position just a few months earlier and had no management or planning experience. He welcomed Mukherji's offer to help him do a better job of planning.

1. What techniques increased Mukherji's communication effectiveness?
2. Do you think that an open-door policy was the right way to improve upward communication?
3. What other techniques would you suggest to improve communication in organization?
4. What problems do you think an open-door policy creates? Do you think many employees are reluctant to use it? Give reasons for your answer.